

Volunteer Management Framework

Volunteer Programme Management Framework

Who to recruit

Before recruiting volunteers, set the foundation of the volunteer programme by conducting a **volunteer Recruitment Needs Analysis**, identifying roles and responsibilities, boundaries (do's and don'ts), and designing accurate volunteer job descriptions to complement paid staff's roles and responsibilities.

To fulfill the vision and mission statements and the goals of the organization; for instance if the organization's mission is to support elders to age-in-place, the attributes of the volunteers must be aligned to those who can relate to and engage the elders in conversations.

Developing the Volunteer Job Description help map out clear expectations and communicate clear, fair boundaries for the volunteers. They also help volunteers understand the expectations and how they can integrate the time requirements into their busy schedules. A good Job Description should explain the assignment thoroughly, outline the skills needed to perform the tasks successfully and specify the type of training and support they will receive.

Map the number of volunteers needed

The next step is to map out the number of volunteers to have for each team or position. This gives an overview of volunteer involvement across the organization and the number that needs to be recruited.

In our case study, 20 new volunteers need to be recruited, and they will be divided into 4 teams to cater to the needs of another 200 elderly clients in 3 months.

Where to recruit

Referrals

Every organization has contacts, whether they are clients, supporters, partners and former volunteers or people who might share the values of the organization's cause. Send out word through the grapevine, such as current volunteers, Facebook, Community Clubs.

Special Events

Holding different types of events such as breakfast meetings, roadshows at the organization's location gives potential volunteers an opportunity to get a feel of the organization's environment, meet the staff, and possibly interact with clients. It is a great way to show how the programmes impact the community positively.

How to Apply

Successful selection is aligning:

- The volunteers' skills, attributes and time availability with the Job Description
- The needs and expectations of the volunteers with the needs and expectations of the organization
- The specificity and matching of the needs of the volunteer to the organisation assure a contributing and meaningful role for the volunteer. If the organisation simply puts out a

list of odd jobs, it is highly unlikely to arouse the enthusiasm of potential volunteers. It is important to identify the skills, knowledge and personal attributes of the potential volunteers needed to do the job.

- It must be remembered that volunteers are seeking value from the experience. They may seek the satisfaction from helping others, or have other personal needs, such as gaining work experience in exchange for contributing their time and skills. Understanding volunteers' motivations is central to involving volunteers successfully in the organisation or a particular project. It should lead to a positive and lasting relationship between the volunteer and the organisation.

Example If a volunteer is considering becoming a carer in the senior services sector, it would not be advisable to fill him/her for a position that involves only filing paperwork where there is no opportunity to contact the clients. The volunteer is unlikely to stay on as a volunteer.

- To facilitate the matching of the attributes of the volunteer to the job description, design an application form with specific questions to ascertain the volunteer's compatibility for the role is definitive.

Field	Input / Options
Name:	
Address and Contact Details	
Age:	
Current Employment Status	Full-time ☐ Part-time ☐ Probationary ☐ Contract: ☐
Why are you interested in a volunteer position with a Senior Services organisation?	
Summary of qualifications	
Do you have experience working in this field?	Yes ☐ No ☐
If yes, please give details, including position held, and length of time working in the field	
Referees: (Please indicate the names, positions and contact details of two referees)	
Please describe any personal qualities you feel you possess which would assist you in this role.	
Rate your understanding of English:	Poor ☐ Fair ☐ Good ☐ Excellent ☐
Other languages spoken:	
Interests and hobbies:	

Availability: (Please indicate the number of hours per week you are available to volunteer)	
Time preferences: (Please indicate your available days and times)	
Are you prepared to undergo a police clearance prior to commencing a volunteer position at this organisation?	Yes ☐ No ☐

Shortlist Potential Candidates for Interview

- Screen the applicants for interview using the **agreed** criteria for matching requirements of the organisation with the skills, experience and personal attributes of the applicants.
- Contact the shortlisted applicants to arrange for the time and place to meet for the interviews. Interviewing potential volunteers should be informal. Be flexible when arranging for the time and a convenient place to meet.
- Establish an interview panel, if necessary.
- Develop a checklist for the orientation interview so that nothing is left out. This includes the interview questions.
- Conduct each interview within half an hour to an hour. Make notes at each interview. *(Interviewer speaks as much, if not more)*
- Get back to the applicants after the interview to inform them of the outcomes of their applications.

(6) Select Suitable Volunteers after Interview

- It is vital to ensure that **policies and procedures** are followed consistently throughout the volunteer screening and selection process.
Pertinent examples are:
 - *Equal opportunity and who can join the programme*
 - *How volunteers are to be managed*
 - *Volunteer agreements*
 - *Tasks the volunteers can do*
 - *Areas in which the volunteers can work*
 - *Conditions of volunteer employment*
 - *Ensuring the rights of volunteers*
 - *Reimbursements for out-of-pocket expenses and travel allowance*
 - *Personal details and privacy, security and confidentiality (Handwritten note: PDPA)*
 - *Handling **grievances** and disciplinary action. (operating boundaries)*

- It will then be necessary to identify generic qualities the organisation requires in the people it recruits to meet the specific requirements ascertained from the analysis of the organisation's needs.

Inform applicants of the outcome according to organizational procedures

Once the relevant checks have been carried out (example Google search of candidates background, police search), successful applicants are recommended to the management for approval. All applicants are notified whether they are successful or not.

Unsuccessful applicants are notified through email, thank them for their interest and request permission to retain their personal data for future references if there are suitable positions that require their skills and attributes.

Successful applicants: follow-up with an email advising candidates of their appointments and providing them with instructions for the completion of the application process, such as meeting with HR, or being fitted with uniforms.

Successful applicants will need to be prepared for the commencement of their role in the organization:

- Meet the staff members who will be involved with the volunteers
- Receive details of the orientation programme
- Attend the orientation programme
- Sign the volunteer agreement with the organization

Deployment of Volunteers

A formal volunteer deployment policy relating to the following must be put in place:

- Recruitment of volunteers
 - Their roles within the organization
 - Accessing information and training
 - Appraisal and feedback processes
 - The right to feel safe and secure at work
 - Accessing mechanisms such as grievances handling
 - Specific and accurate job descriptions of the volunteer
 - Disciplinary procedures
 - Remuneration and compensation, if any
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Volunteer Leadership Framework

Recommended Volunteer Leadership Framework

- **Header Notes:**
 - Skilled communicator
 - Manage Self
- **Core Principle:** At the heart of the Framework is the relationship between the team leader and team members. This is a ‘two-way, trusting, productive, working relationship focused on achieving the organisation’s goals with each person working to their full potential’.

Volunteer Leadership Framework Diagram

The framework is structured as a central hub with six interconnected pillars of leadership competency:

Pillar	Key Competencies
Lead Strategically	Think strategically, Create a vision, Set goals & Objectives, Think analytically to solve problems
Lead People	Negotiation, Delegation, Supervision, Conflict Resolution
Lead Change	Thinking creatively, Foster Innovation, Managing Change, Influencing others
Lead Projects	Project Management, Project Planning, Offer Quality Services to Clients
Skilled Communicator	Positive, Giving and Receiving Feedback, Assertiveness, Listening
Manage Self	Emotional Intelligence, Understanding Self and Others, Managing time and stress

Effectiveness Factors: The effectiveness of this leadership framework relies on three factors: Organization Culture, Designed Leadership, and Organization Design.

Volunteer Leadership Pathway

Steps in the Volunteer Leadership Pathway may include:

1. Introduce leadership opportunities to new volunteers to prepare them for their future roles.
2. Managers and supervisors observe to identify potential leaders.
3. Volunteers assess their leadership skills to identify training opportunities to close skill gaps.

4. The organisation selects leaders and train them for their roles.
5. Create opportunities for them to lead volunteer-led initiatives and activities.
6. Appraise and provide feedback to improve their leadership skills.

Visual Representation of the Pathway

The visual roadmap illustrates the progression from a new recruit to a strategic leader:

- **Level 1: New Volunteer**
 - **Needs:** Orientation, induction, job roles & description.
 - **Action:** Introduce Leadership development opportunity.
 - **Level 2: Team Member**
 - **Needs:** Teamwork, collaboration, Care services, Manage Self, Communication.
 - **Action:** Preparing for leadership.
 - **Level 3: Volunteer Leader**
 - **Needs:** Lead strategically, Lead people, Lead change, Lead projects.
 - **Action:** Build strategic muscles, sharpening skills.
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Best Practices and Activity

Notes

- The above roadmap will encourage volunteers to take charge of their training which will lead to more qualified volunteer leaders to assist the organisation to achieve its mission and goals.
- Volunteer leadership is team-based.
- Setting up teams to address critical organisational or mission-centered issues is key to increase the capabilities of volunteer leadership.
- Therefore, investing in building the leader and team capabilities will enable staff members to 'let go' of control and delegate greater responsibility to volunteers.

Leadership Best Practices

- Recognise contributions and celebrate values and victories.
- Clarify values and set the example.
- Envision the future and enlist in a common vision.
- Look for opportunities to improve and learn from experience.
- Foster collaboration, increase self-direction and develop competence.

Design ONE training program for the current and new volunteers that will address the immediate issues faced by the center

Refer Tab: **Course Curriculum**

Recommend TWO strategies to create opportunities for volunteers to initiate and implement community activities to serve the elderly clients better.

1. Tap on volunteers' interests and motivation to design initiatives or activities. Be open and listen objectively. Volunteers are then subject matter experts (SME) and they will be comfortable to initiate programs.
 2. Discuss planned initiatives and activities to let them decide if they have the required skills and capabilities to lead the project. Volunteers will be motivated to do well, provide good volunteering experience and they will stay on.
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Course Curriculum

1. Course Curriculum

The curriculum follows the WSQ (Workforce Skills Qualifications) framework under the Progressive Wage Model (PWM) for the Cleaning Sector to ensure compliance with Singapore's Ministry of Manpower (MOM) and SkillsFuture Singapore (SSG) regulations.

- **Module 1: Safe Work Practices and Risk Control**
 - Understanding the importance of Workplace Safety and Health (WSH)
 - Interpretation of WSH Act and organizational WSH policies
 - Following WSH risk control measures within the work area
 - Adopting risk-based thinking in working practices
 - WSH reasonable practical risk control measures
 - **Module 2: Potential Hazards and Unsafe Work Practices**
 - Identifying common risks and hazards in the environmental services industry
 - Chemical hazards (cleaning agents, disinfectants)
 - Physical hazards (slips, trips, falls, manual handling)
 - Biological hazards (waste materials, contaminated surfaces)
 - Recognizing unsafe acts or conditions in the work environment
 - Understanding consequences of poor working practices
 - **Module 3: Workplace Emergency Response**
 - Emergency response procedures for the cleaning sector
 - Accident reporting procedures
 - First aid awareness
 - Evacuation protocols
 - Immediate response to workplace incidents
 - Reporting unsafe working conditions or work practices by organizational procedures
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 - **Module 4: Practical Application Components**
 - Apply safe work practices and risk control
 - Identify potential hazards and unsafe work practices
 - Perform workplace emergency response
 - Report to supervisors any unsafe acts or conditions in accordance with company procedures
 - Adhere to workplace safety and health practices according to organizational procedures
 - Recommending corrective and preventive actions (CAPA).
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2. Training Duration

- **Full Program:** 8 hours (typically conducted over **1 full day**).
 - **Assessment:** Includes a written test and a practical/oral assessment (approx. 1 hour) on the final day.
 - **Total Course Duration:** 9 hours (including assessment)
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3. Mode of Training

- **Hybrid / Blended Learning:**
 - **In-Person:**
 - Facilitated classroom training for practical exercises
 - Hands-on demonstrations of safety practices
 - Interactive learning activities
 - Mock scenarios for hazard identification
 - Group discussions and case studies
 - *Note: Most WSQ providers now use Singpass for digital attendance taking. 100% attendance is mandatory for course completion. No exceptions for partial attendance.*

4. Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, learners will be able to:

Knowledge Outcomes:

- Understand the importance of Workplace Safety and Health (WSH) and how it affects their work
- 2. Identify common risks and hazards involved in the environmental services industry
- 3. Understand organizational reporting procedures for WSH-related matters
- 4. Comprehend WSH risk control measures and their application

Skill Outcomes

- Group discussions and case studies
- Follow stipulated WSH practices to prevent accidents or minimize risks
- Apply safe work practices and risk control measures within the work area
- Identify unsafe acts or conditions present in the work environment
- Participate in workplace safety and health practices within the scope of their role and responsibilities

- Perform appropriate workplace emergency response procedures

Ability to Comply

- Report unsafe working conditions or work practices in accordance with organizational procedures
- 2. Notify supervisors of unsafe acts or conditions according to company procedures
- 3. Adhere to workplace safety and health practices according to organizational guidelines
- 4. Follow organizational WSH policies and procedures to prevent accidents or minimize risks

5. Mode of Assessment

- Practical assessment (hands-on demonstration)
- Oral assessment (verbal questioning)
- 100% assessment required for competency certification

6. Program Fees (Estimated)

Fees are standardized across approved training providers (e.g., Assure Safety, Training Masters, AKC, Greensafe International, NTUC LearningHub).

Category	Estimated Fee (incl. GST)
Full Course Fee	S\$200.00 (before GST) S\$218.00 (with GST)
Singaporeans/PRs (Aged 21-39)	S\$100.00 (before GST) S\$118.00 (with GST) (50% subsidy)
Singaporeans (Aged 40+ / SME-sponsored)	S\$60.00 (before GST) S\$78.00 (with GST) (70% subsidy)
Company sponsored (Non-SME)	S\$100.00 (before GST) S\$118.00 (with GST) (50% subsidy)

Can be fully offset using **SkillsFuture Credit** or **PSEA funds**.

7. Certification upon Completion

Statement of Attainment (SOA)** issued by SkillsFuture Singapore (SSG)

- Valid for employment in PWM-Cleaning sector
- Recognized by National Environment Agency (NEA)
- Required for cleaning business licensing under PWM framework

8. Simple Incident Report Template

This template aligns with MOM's **iReport** requirements.

INCIDENT REPORT FORM

| Section 1: Reporter Details | |

| Name: | Contact No: |

| Designation: | Date of Report: |

Section 2: Incident Overview	
Date & Time of Incident:	Location:
Type: ☐ Accident ☐ Near-Miss ☐ Dangerous Occurrence ☐ Property Damage	

Section 3: Affected Person(s)	
Name:	NRIC/FIN:
Occupation:	Nature of Injury:

Section 4: Description of Event *What happened? (Describe sequence of events, machinery involved, and immediate actions taken):*

Section 5: Witness Statement Name:

Section 6: Analysis & Action
Root Cause:
Corrective Action (To fix now):
Preventive Action (To prevent recurrence):

9. What to bring

- NRIC or identification document
- Comfortable and practical clothing suitable for workshop environment
- ****Closed-toe shoes are mandatory**** for safety reasons
- Writing materials for notes
- Singpass login credentials for attendance verification

10. External Resources

- **Course Search:** [MySkillsFuture Course Directory](#) (Search for "WSH Incident Management").
- **Official Reporting:** [MOM WSH Incident Reporting \(iReport\)](#).
- **Framework Details:** [Skills Framework for Workplace Safety and Health](#).
- **WSQ Competency Standard**:** EVS-WSH-1006-1.1 (Comply with Workplace Safety and Health Policies and Procedures)
- MySkillsFuture Course Directory**: Search for "PWM-Cleaning Workplace Safety" or use TGS code. Website: <https://www.myskillsfuture.gov.sg> (<https://www.myskillsfuture.gov.sg>)
- Ministry of Manpower (MOM)**: Workplace Safety and Health regulations

- Website:
<https://www.mom.gov.sg/workplace-safety-and-health>

11. Training Providers

1. Training Masters Workforce Institute Pte Ltd
2. Assure Safety Pte Ltd
3. Greensafe International Pte Ltd
4. AKC Education Centre
5. NTUC LearningHub
6. Ascendo Academy Pte Ltd
7. UBTS Academy Pte Ltd
8. Focus Learning Centre Pte Ltd
9. Literacy Empowerment Academy Pte Ltd
10. Bespoke Solution Training Consultancy Pte Ltd
11. Adecco Consultants Pte Ltd
12. Astute Professional Training Academy Pte Ltd

Budgeting

Budget and Resources

Budgeting for volunteer programs helps an organization focus on reaching its goals. The budget typically includes the following main categories:

- **Direct Costs:** Costs directly related to a specific project or volunteer-run program.
- **Capital Expenditures:** Items with lasting value, such as cars, real estate, computers, or laptops.
- **Indirect ("Hidden") Costs:** Costs not project-related but necessary to ensure the program functions successfully.
- **In-kind contributions:** Donations of goods or services used to complete projects.

Other Expense Categories include:

- **General Marketing:** Website design, SEO, brochures, and promo items (noted as an *indirect cost*).
- **Volunteer Recruitment and Orientation:** Online postings, background checks, and orientation programs (noted as a *direct cost*).

Key Principles:

- **Reward:** Sending a volunteer to a training program or conference can serve as a recognition and reward for their service. This keeps volunteers committed and enable them to perform to the standards required (example WSH training for safe practices at workplaces).
- **Broad Interests:** Training does not have to be directly related to the volunteer's role; it can cover broad interests like CPR, public speaking, or team building.
- **Retention:** Replacing volunteers is expensive. A modest budget that values their presence supports their loyalty and continuation with the organization.
- **Volunteer Retention:** Special events such as quarterly potluck, recognition items, food and beverage vouchers

Develop a Training Budget Plan

1. Integration and Planning:

- Include the Volunteer Programme Management Budget in the annual training budget of the organization.
- Fiscal planning usually begins 3 to 6 months before the start of the next fiscal year.

- The Volunteer Management Practitioner (VMP) should develop the Total Volunteer Training Plan 1 to 2 months before the annual budget is drafted.

2. Establishing the Budget:

- Allocating resources ensures they are aligned with organizational needs to achieve desired results.
- **Rules of Thumb:** Most organizations allocate 1% to 5% of total staff salaries for training in their annual budget. For example, a \$500,000 salary spend at 3% results in a \$15,000 training budget (though this often excludes volunteers).
- **Needs-Based Budgeting:** Since there is no set formula for volunteers, a "Needs-Based Budget" is used by listing the cost of per item needed for training.

Examples of Needs-Based Costs:

- **In-person training:** May include training materials, venue, and transportation.
- **Online training:** Typically only includes the training materials.

Identifying Training Expenses

Tips: The best situation to create a budget based on needs is to identify the needs 1 to 2 months ahead of the annual budgeting exercise. These needs should be backed by a strategic approach because research and calculation for this method take significantly more time.

Identify Training Expenses A typical list of Volunteer Training expenses includes:

- **Direct Expenditures:** Costs directly related to professional development, such as conference fees, seminar fees, trainer/instructor fees, venue, materials, and food & beverage. [Course fees for WSH Course training is Direct Costs paid to external training provider](#)
- **Capital Expenditures:** Items with lasting value like projectors, Learning Management System (LMS) software, hardware/software, and medical equipment.
- **Indirect ("Hidden") Expenditures:** Overhead or administrative costs necessary for successful functioning, such as the cost per administrative staff involved in organizing programs.
- **In-Kind Contributions:** "Free" goods or services used to motivate volunteers, such as rewards after completing a course.

In-person Training versus Online Training Organizations should consider the relative costs of in-person versus online formats when working out expenses.

Relative Costs and Budget Allocation

Training Type	Training Format	Relative Cost
On-the-job coaching & mentoring	In-person	\$
Being a sponsor of an apprentice	In-person	\$
Self-directed study	Online	\$
Video presentations	Online	\$
Job shadowing	In-person	\$
e-learning	Online	\$\$
Seminars	In-person/Online	\$\$
One-to-one tutoring	In-person/Online	\$\$
Certifiable courses	In-person/Online	\$\$\$
Group workshops (external)	In-person/Online	\$\$\$
Consultant training (in-house)	In-person	\$\$-\$\$\$

Drafting a Projected Training Budget Plan According to Capterra, an effective budget allocation for training looks like this:

- **50%:** Training high-calibre staff so they can train other employees.
- **25%:** Training tools and technologies.
- **20%:** Developing the training content.
- **5%:** Miscellaneous items like food and drinks.

For every category in the training budget, compare receipts from past years and strategically plan with the team how to reduce or increase costs in order to better manage the budget. At the same time, set a deadline to finalize the training budget.

Sample Annual Basic Training Budget of \$5,260 for (20 existing + 20 new) volunteers

Items	Costs	Remarks
WSQ WSH Workplace Safety & Health	\$4,360	All volunteers (existing and new) to attend training (9% GST)
Rewards for completing the training or	\$400	Rewards can be shopping or

programme certification. (40 pax)		meals vouchers
In-house familiarization training	\$500	Purchase cleaning equipment for volunteers to get familiar with use of various cleaning tools
Total Budget for next financial year	**\$5,260**	

Finalizing the Projected Budget Check and double-check numbers to ensure the budget is realistic before presenting it professionally to a board of directors for approval. References are made to other training budget samples by other NGOs.

Monitoring the Budget

1. How to Monitor the Budget Budgets should be monitored regularly (quarterly, monthly, or weekly) to identify problems before they become costly mistakes.

- 1. Appoint a Budget Holder:** This person establishes the actual position of the budget, adjusts for outstanding transactions, and tracks "committed" funds for confirmed activities. This person needs to know the current status of the budget and adjust it for any outstanding transactions.
- 2. Comparing actual with budget:** Gathered information must be compared to figures set at the start of the financial year.
- 3. Calculating variances:** 'Variance' refers to the difference between actual and planned income and expenditure.
- 4. Taking action to exert control:** Budget can only be controlled if corrective action is taken in response to the variances. Variances that arise because of fundamental changes require action.

Items	Budgeted Costs	Actual Costs	Variance
			0
External Training by 3rd party	\$4,760	\$47600	\$0
*In-house Training	\$500	\$600	-\$100
Rewards for completing training or certification	\$400	\$400	\$0
Total	\$5,260	\$5,360	-\$100

Orientation

Design an effective Orientation Programme for the center's newly recruited volunteers to equip them with the essential knowledge to perform their roles. Explain the rationale for the outline.

Volunteer Orientation and Training Programmes (A4, A9)

- When volunteers are recruited to join the organisation, a well-developed orientation and training programmes must be put in place to equip them with the essential skills and knowledge to enable them to perform their roles effectively. This will also benefit the organisation because strategic goals will be met with the help of trained and motivated volunteers. As such, it is crucial to identify the synergies across programmes and departments to maximise the values and effectiveness of these volunteer programmes.
- The HR department must ensure the volunteers are provided with the following information prior to the orientation programme.
 - All new volunteers will be provided with a copy of the organisation's policy on Volunteerism.
 - New volunteers must complete the Orientation programme successfully within one month of the appointment.
 - All volunteers will have a designated supervisor and receive regular supervision in line with their duties and responsibilities.
 - Volunteers will be covered under directors' and officers' liability insurance, professional indemnity and personal accident insurance.
 - Any grievances will be addressed in accordance with the principles and procedures outlined in the 'Policy on Staff Grievances'.

Purpose of (a) Orientation Programme

- An orientation programme welcomes volunteers to an organisation and assists them prepare for their role by providing the necessary information, resources and motivation to assist new volunteers to adjust to the work environment quickly. Studies have shown that a good Orientation programme correlates with increasing productivity, decreasing volunteer turnover and reducing the frequency of workplace injuries.
 - The type of Orientation programme is largely dependent on the purpose of the recruitment, the types of tasks volunteers are performing, the available resources and timeframe.
 - Ideally, the Orientation programme should be implemented directly prior to the first day of work for the volunteer and follow up training to be scheduled once the learning needs are identified.
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① Volunteer Handbook

- An information kit should be provided at the orientation meeting. The kit could include pertinent procedures, work dates and locations, contact lists, WSH information, first-aid and suggestions on what to wear and bring to workdays. Keep the information simple and succinct. Avoid overwhelming people with pages of information and details on everything they need to know about the programme. They should be able to receive the relevant information in stages through other means including training, emails, e-newsletter, websites, social media, webinars and so on.

Topics for orientation | Recommended topics | | :--- | | - History, mission, vision and values of organisation. | | - Strategic Direction and Goals | | - Organisational Structure | | - Overview of Volunteer Management System | | - Overview of services and service users | | - Volunteer Roles, Rights and Responsibilities. | | - Key policies and procedures which include Code of Conduct of Volunteer, WSH, Personal Data Protection Act, Privacy & Confidentiality, Grievance Process | | - Workplace Safety & Health issues and procedures. | | - Training and Performance management programmes. | | - Reward and recognition programmes and initiatives | | - The expected level of support and supervision. | | - Feedback channels | | - Volunteer Agreement |

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- During the orientation, provide information about upcoming meetings and training opportunities.

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- Potential volunteers should know about the **Volunteer Agreement** which is usually signed after the Orientation programme when the volunteer is matched with a volunteer job. This provides an opportunity for both parties to talk through their rights and responsibilities.
 - A volunteer agreement provides a code of conduct which clearly informs volunteers about what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organisation. Volunteer agreements are not legally binding but can establish a commitment by volunteers and the organisation to the volunteering relationship.

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- There are positives and negatives for volunteer agreements. For example, a potential volunteer might be very promising, but unwilling to sign an agreement which they feel would be restrictive to their role. On the other hand, volunteer agreements can be an awareness-raising tool to clarify the expectations and demonstrate that the organisation places a high importance on volunteering.

Volunteer Agreement (sample)

The Volunteer agrees to:	The organisation agrees to:
☐ I accept the responsibilities and limits set out in the Volunteer Position Description.	☐ Provide appropriate orientation and training.
☐ I understand my rights as a volunteer, as outlined in the written information given to me.	☐ Provide technical advice, guidance and assistance to volunteers.
☐ I agree to work in a manner that is safe for myself, other volunteers, paid staff and members of the public.	☐ Provide necessary safety equipment for volunteer tasks.
☐ I agree to participate in orientation and training programmes as required.	☐ Assist with grant applications and facilitate appropriate expenditure of grant funds.
☐ I agree to take part in any technical and safety training that is required.	☐ Provide guidance and advice in supervising programmes and projects.
☐ I agree to accept guidance and direction from the supervisor charged with those duties.	☐ Establish a clear plan which outlines volunteer activities and tasks.
☐ I agree to work as part of a team (if applicable).	☐ Cover volunteers for insurance in case of injury.
☐ I agree not to work unsupervised unless authorised to do so.	☐ Provide information on organisational changes or new policy decisions relevant to volunteers.
☐ I agree to sign the Volunteer Attendance Record at each volunteering session.	☐ Provide an avenue where volunteers can raise questions, concerns and/or complaints.
☐ I agree to report any accident or injury to the programme coordinator within 48 hours.	☐ Encourage and recognise volunteer efforts and achievements.
☐ I agree to advise the programme coordinator if I cannot attend a work session.	☐ Provide feedback on volunteering efforts and achievements.

☐ I agree not to disclose any confidential or sensitive information to any person.
☐ I agree to support a non-discriminatory and harassment-free work environment.

Orientation Checklist

Task	Completed	Notes
Welcome and Introduction	☐	
Tour of Premises	☐	
Introduction to Team	☐	
Review of Job Description	☐	
Health and Safety Briefing	☐	
Confidentiality/PDPA Briefing	☐	
System/Equipment Access	☐	
Uniform/ID Badge Issued	☐	

Develop Orientation Programmes When developing orientation programmes, consider the following activities:

- Form a small working party consisting of managers, volunteers and HR staff, to ascertain what is required in the volunteer orientation programme.
 - Survey the current volunteers to find out what issues need to be considered and included in an orientation programme.
 - Ensure the orientation programme is consistent with organisation volunteer policy.
 - Make the orientation programme easily accessible to all volunteers from the various departments.
 - Ensure the orientation programme is reviewed and updated regularly so that information remains current and relevant to the new volunteers.
 - Balance the content of an orientation programme to ensure it does not overwhelm the new volunteers. Common pitfalls to avoid in developing the orientation programme include:
 - Providing too much information, too soon.
 - Pitching presentations and materials at an inappropriate level - either too high or too low.
 - Creating a programme that generates unrealistic expectations.
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Suggested Orientation programme for the center's newly recruited volunteers

Item	Person-in-charge	Time
Ice breaker	Center Manager (CM)	10 minutes (m)
Mission, Vision, Goals	CM	10m
Organization chart	CM	5m
Groups led by Senior Volunteer; group by roles & responsibilities, briefing on do's and don't's, scope of work, timeframe of volunteers' work	Senior Volunteer (SV)	60m
Briefing WSH Act, best practices, discipline, grievances handling channels	Volunteer Manager (VM)	15m
Training, how to apply theory to practice	VM	15m
What support are available to volunteers	VM	10m
Feedback	VM	5m
Networking; food & beverage	All	To end of orientation

Risk Mitigation

Identify TWO risks in mitigating the volunteer programmes and devise ONE mitigating action plan for each identified risk.

Mitigating Volunteer Programme Risks

2.5 Mitigating Volunteer Programme Risks This section summarizes the white paper "Risk Management for Your Volunteer Program 2015-2016".

Definition of 'Risk'

- **Basic Definition:** A risk is a deviation from the norm, often defined as an event or consequence that can be positive, negative, or neutral.
- **Four Typical Areas of Risk:**
 1. The organization's long-term strategy (3 to 5+ years).
 2. Change management (e.g., during mergers or restructuring).
 3. Day-to-day operations.
 4. General financial health.

Examples of Volunteer Programme Risks

- Interruptions of organizational processes due to government regulations, economic, or social conditions. (*Handwritten note: "COVID: wear mask"*)
- Unforeseen changes in strategic partnerships, key volunteer relationships, and vendor sources. (*Handwritten note: "F+B vendor"*)
- Changes affecting volunteer availability and costs.
- Issues with computer system integrations, networks, or accounting systems. (*Handwritten note: "Y2K"*)
- Security conditions affecting operations. (*Handwritten note: "availability volunteer change schedule"*)

ISO 31000 Risk Management Standard

- Defines risk as "the effect of uncertainty on objectives".
- It is the process of identifying threats, evaluating financial/punitive impacts, and taking measures to protect the company, community, and clients.

Risk Management Process and Strategies

Consequences of Poor Risk Management

If overlooked, risks can lead to:

- Tarnished organizational reputation.
- Irrelevant assets.
- Compromised safety.
- High volunteer attrition rates.

Risk Management Methodology & Process

This diagram illustrates a continuous cycle for managing risks:

Process Step	Description
Set the Context	Assess strategic, organizational, and risk management context.
Identify Risks	Determine "What can go wrong?"
Analyse Risks	Assess the probability and impact of the risk; review existing controls.
Assess & Prioritise	Compare risks to determine which need action first.
Treat the Risks	Reduce probability or impact through specific response options.

Note: Throughout this process, "Communicate & Consult" and "Track & Review" are ongoing activities.

Risk Mitigation Strategies

While the text notes four strategies, three are detailed on this page:

1. **Risk Avoidance:** Planning to eliminate the risk entirely.
2. **Transference of Risk:** Using third-party insurance to compensate if something goes wrong.
3. **Risk Mitigation:** Attempting to reduce the impact or probability. This involves creating a **contingency plan** to lessen damage when highly probable risks occur.

Identify TWO risks in mitigating the volunteer programmes and devise ONE mitigating action plan for each identified risk.

Applying the **ISO 31000 Risk Management Process** and the mitigation strategies extracted from your documents, here are the mitigating action plans for the two scenarios.

Scenario 1: F&B Vendor Delivery Failure

Scenario 1: The failure of a vendor to deliver food impacts volunteer morale and the overall success of the event.

Stage	Action Plan Details
Risk Analysis	Impact: High (Reputational damage and dissatisfied participants). Probability: Moderate (Logistics issues/miscommunication).
Mitigation Strategy	Contingency Planning (Mitigation)
Action Steps	1. Confirmation Protocol: The Volunteer Management Practitioner (VMP) must call the vendor 48 hours and 3 hours before the event. 2. Backup Vendor List: Maintain a "Quick-Response" list of nearby fast-food outlets or caterers capable of providing bulk orders within 60 minutes. 3. Payment Leverage: Use a deposit-based payment system rather than full upfront payment to ensure vendor accountability.
Communication	Assign a dedicated "Logistics Lead" to monitor delivery status. If the vendor is 15 minutes late, trigger the backup list immediately.



Scenario: Unplanned Unavailability of Volunteers

Risk Context: Shortage of manpower can lead to compromised safety and operational gaps during the event

Stage	Action Plan Details
Risk Analysis	Impact: High (Operational failure, safety risks). Probability: High (Unforeseen emergencies/attrition).
Mitigation Strategy	Risk Reduction (Redundancy/Buffer)
Action Steps	1. The 20% Rule: Always recruit and orient 20% more volunteers than the "Minimum Required" to serve as a Reserve Pool. 2. Cross-Training: Ensure all volunteers receive a "Generalist" briefing so they can be reassigned to critical roles if a specialist fails to show. 3. Early Check-In: Require digital check-in via an app or SMS 2 hours before the shift starts to identify gaps early.
Communication	Maintain a "Standby" WhatsApp group for the Reserve Pool who are compensated with "In-kind" vouchers even if they are not eventually activated.

Summary of Strategies Used

- **Scenario 1** focuses on **Contingency Planning**: Having a "Plan B" (backup vendors) ready to reduce the impact of a negative event.
- **Scenario 2** focuses on **Risk Reduction**: Increasing resources (Reserve Pool) to lower the probability of a manpower "deviation from the norm."